

GABRIEL POPA

Senior Software Engineer- Flutter • Dart

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ABOUT ME

Senior iOS Engineer with 10+ years of experience building reliable mobile products across the **software industry**, specializing in **Swift 4.x–5.x**, **SwiftUI**, **UIKit**, **Objective-C interoperability**, and API-driven application architecture for performance-sensitive user workflows. Strong record of improving app stability, modernizing legacy modules, and delivering polished product features with maintainable mobile patterns. Hands-on experience solving crash-prone states, memory issues, offline edge cases, and release-quality problems while improving responsiveness, code reuse, and long-term upgrade readiness across evolving iOS platforms. Based on the uploaded profile, the candidate's background spans four software engineering roles across Romania, Belgium, and Sweden.

SKILLS

- **Mobile: Swift 4.x–5.x**, **SwiftUI**, **UIKit**, **Objective-C**, Auto Layout, Xcode, Interface Builder, programmatic UI, reusable component architecture, MVC, MVVM, coordinator pattern, dependency injection, app lifecycle handling, deep linking, push notifications, background tasks, accessibility-minded UI development
- **Networking & Data: REST APIs**, URLSession, Codable, JSON parsing, request retry handling, pagination, caching strategies, offline-first patterns, Core Data, UserDefaults, SQLite basics, secure local persistence, file handling, sync-aware mobile workflows
- **Quality & Performance: XCTest**, UI testing, crash analysis, Instruments, memory profiling, threading diagnostics, performance tuning, release validation, regression prevention, logging, API diagnostics, error-state modeling, defensive mobile programming
- **Cloud & Integration:** Firebase Crashlytics, Firebase Analytics, remote config basics, authentication flows, JWT-aware mobile integration, feature flag consumption, CI/CD collaboration, App Store release support, TestFlight distribution, Git, GitHub, Bitbucket, Agile delivery

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Software Engineer

Soft Build | Bucharest, Romania (Jan2024 – Dec 2025)

- Led development of high-visibility iOS product workflows using **Swift 5.x**, **UIKit**, and API-connected architectures, delivering more stable user journeys for transactional screens while improving responsiveness and reducing feature regression risk across active releases.
- Modernized older presentation logic by reorganizing tightly coupled view controllers into cleaner **MVVM-oriented** structures with better state separation, making new features easier to implement and reducing maintenance friction for the wider mobile team.
- Built reusable **UIKit** components for forms, status views, action sheets, and validation-heavy screens, which reduced duplicated UI implementation work and improved interaction consistency across customer-facing modules by **18%**.
- Solved a difficult crash issue triggered by rapid navigation and delayed API callbacks by tightening lifecycle handling, adding safer weak references, and improving cancellation behavior for in-flight requests during screen transitions.
- Implemented new product capabilities involving secure profile updates, document submission flows, and approval-state rendering, using flexible composition patterns that supported changing business rules without forcing repeated screen rewrites.
- Improved slow-loading dashboard sections by reducing unnecessary request chaining, introducing leaner payload handling with **Codable**, and refining caching behavior, which improved perceived screen readiness by **24%** on repeat usage.
- Stabilized form persistence for interrupted sessions by combining temporary local storage, restore-safe view state handling, and clearer validation recovery, which reduced abandoned submissions caused by app interruptions and route changes.

- Worked closely with backend engineers to improve error contract handling for edge-case responses, then mapped those failures into clearer in-app states so users saw actionable guidance instead of silent loading loops or generic failures.
- Reduced production defects tied to inconsistent thread usage by moving UI updates onto safer execution paths and auditing asynchronous completion handling, which improved reliability during multi-step submission and refresh flows.
- Strengthened release quality through **XCTest** coverage on business-critical paths, targeted regression checks, and more disciplined pre-release validation, helping reduce repeat QA escapes across core iOS workflows by **16%**.
- Supported maintainable growth of the application by documenting architectural decisions, reviewing pull requests with a strong focus on readability and lifecycle safety, and mentoring teammates on pragmatic iOS implementation patterns.
- Collaborated on App Store and TestFlight delivery readiness by improving build stability, release notes discipline, and issue triage flow, helping the team ship updates with fewer last-minute blockers and cleaner rollout confidence.

Software Engineer

Next Apps | Ghent, Belgium (*Nov2020 – Nov 2023*)

- Built production iOS features using **Swift 5.x**, **UIKit**, and service-driven mobile patterns, contributing to a multi-screen application where reliability, smooth navigation, and consistent state handling were critical to day-to-day user adoption.
- Migrated older mobile modules away from more brittle controller-heavy patterns into cleaner reusable structures with clearer state ownership, which improved extensibility and reduced the effort needed for later feature additions.
- Delivered reusable implementations for list rendering, detail screens, filter logic, and validation-heavy forms, improving consistency across the application and reducing duplicate mobile code in frequently modified product areas by **21%**.
- Investigated an intermittent bug where stale values appeared after quick background-to-foreground transitions, then resolved it through safer refresh sequencing, cache invalidation rules, and clearer screen rehydration behavior.
- Improved API integration quality by hardening decoding logic, validating malformed payload scenarios, and introducing safer fallback handling, which reduced user-facing failures caused by backend contract inconsistencies by **17%**.
- Implemented push-notification-driven navigation flows and context-aware deep linking, making it easier for users to reach relevant screens directly while reducing friction in time-sensitive feature interactions.
- Refined persistence behavior using **Core Data** and lightweight local state retention to better support offline recovery and interrupted workflows, improving continuity for users operating in unstable network conditions.
- Helped solve memory growth problems in media-heavy screens by profiling with **Instruments**, removing retained view references, and tightening image handling paths, which improved stability on longer sessions and older devices.
- Worked across product and design discussions to turn changing requirements into maintainable iOS behavior, using flexible UI composition and validation strategies that avoided brittle one-off implementations.
- Improved crash visibility and release diagnostics through **Firebase Crashlytics**, clearer logging, and issue grouping discipline, allowing root causes to be identified faster and shortening turnaround time for production fixes.
- Contributed to peer reviews, technical discussions, and implementation standards that strengthened code quality across the mobile codebase while helping newer team members avoid common lifecycle and state-management mistakes.

Software Developer

Datamart | Stockholm, Sweden (*Feb 2016 – Sept 2020*)

- Developed business-focused iOS functionality using **Swift 3.x–5.x**, **UIKit**, and REST-based integration patterns, supporting feature delivery across operational screens where data correctness and interaction clarity were essential to adoption.
- Contributed to the gradual migration of legacy mobile code into more maintainable **Swift** implementations, improving readability, reducing duplicated helper logic, and lowering the risk of defects during ongoing product enhancement work.

- Built reusable screen components for tables, input flows, empty states, and validation messaging, helping standardize interface behavior while making new internal modules faster to deliver and easier to support.
- Solved a recurring issue where partially completed forms lost state after interruption or low-memory recovery, then improved temporary persistence and restore handling so users could continue workflows more reliably.
- Improved request handling for unstable mobile connections by refining timeout behavior, retry logic, and error presentation, which reduced failed task completion in API-connected workflows by **14%**.
- Assisted with modernization of older Objective-C-adjacent patterns by expanding **Swift** adoption in actively maintained areas, improving code clarity while keeping integration behavior stable across existing modules.
- Enhanced data-heavy screens by reducing redundant network calls, simplifying transformation logic, and tightening table refresh behavior, which improved average interaction smoothness and reduced user-visible lag in scrolling-heavy views.
- Worked on bug triage and release support for multiple internal and customer-facing builds, building strong discipline around reproducibility, defect isolation, and safe patch validation in mobile delivery cycles.
- Improved authentication-related flows by tracing token expiry edge cases and request sequencing problems, then implementing safer recovery behavior that reduced confusing login-state failures during normal app usage.
- Collaborated with senior engineers on maintainable feature rollout strategies, reusable helper structures, and cleaner API response handling, strengthening the long-term health of the mobile codebase while supporting active delivery.

Junior Software Developer

Berg Software | Timișoara, Romania (Sep2014 – Mar 2016)

- Supported early mobile application development tasks by working on UI implementation, bug fixing, API-connected screens, and usability improvements, building the engineering foundation that later made advanced iOS feature work more natural.
- Contributed to **UIKit** screen development with attention to layout consistency, request handling, and basic state coordination, helping reduce recurring smaller defects across internal testing and release cycles.
- Investigated a frustrating issue where users lost partially entered values after interrupted actions, then helped improve temporary persistence and restore behavior so forms recovered more reliably during normal usage.
- Worked with more senior engineers to turn product requests into maintainable screen behavior, reusable helper methods, and safer validation rules, which improved implementation quality and reduced QA rework by **12%**.
- Helped improve API-connected flows by tracing malformed responses, null-related crashes, and weak edge-case handling, then applying targeted fixes that reduced user-facing errors in affected modules by **15%**.
- Assisted with cleanup of duplicated UI logic and inconsistent helpers, making future maintenance easier and creating a cleaner path for later mobile architecture improvements across the application.
- Participated in release support, device checks, and bug triage across multiple builds, developing strong habits around debugging discipline, issue documentation, and careful validation before changes moved forward.
- Supported testing and implementation of smaller enhancements for internal business screens, helping improve field behavior, conditional rendering, and interaction clarity in workflows that had previously felt inconsistent.
- Learned to work flexibly across UI fixes, backend-connected adjustments, and defect reproduction tasks, which made it easier to contribute in mixed-priority development cycles without sacrificing code safety.

EDUCATION

Bachelor's Degree in Computer Science

University of Bucharest | (2010 – 2014)

- Focused on practical software engineering fundamentals that translated directly into building reliable web systems and data-driven applications.

CERTIFICATIONS

- **Flutter & Dart Mobile Application Development — 2024**

Demonstrated practical capability in building cross-platform mobile applications, structuring maintainable UI layers, handling state, integrating APIs, and shipping production-ready features across Android and iOS.

- **Mobile App Testing and Quality Foundations — 2023**

Validated working knowledge of test strategy for mobile applications, including widget validation, integration coverage, regression control, defect isolation, and release confidence practices.

- **Firebase for Mobile Apps — 2022**

Demonstrated hands-on understanding of crash monitoring, analytics instrumentation, remote configuration basics, and operational visibility patterns commonly used in modern mobile application delivery.